PARMAR SSC

PRESENTS

PDF

One liner for actual questions

अब चलेगी घूमती GAME

AII NEW ARCHITECTURE OF INDIA
QUESTION ASKED BY SSC IN 2025
(NEW PATTERN)

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Q1 The ____ statues are an essential example of the Mauryan period's craftsmanship, known for their monumental size and detailed human figures. DP 2025

a)Yaksha
b)Buddha
c)Lion
d)Shiva

- **The Didarganj Yakshi statues** are among the finest examples of craftsmanship from the Mauryan period (around 3rd century BCE). These statues are:
- **Monumental in size** – Large, life-like sculptures that reflect the grandeur of Mauryan art.
- **Highly polished** – They display the famous "Mauryan polish," giving them a smooth, mirror-like surface.
- **Detailed human figures** – Especially known for their realistic depiction of the human body, ornaments, and drapery.
- The most famous example, the Didarganj Yakshi, was found near **Patna (Bihar)** and represents a female figure (Yakshi) holding a chauri (fly-whisk), symbolizing beauty and fertility.

Q2 The painting "Mahishasura", which blends mythology with expressionism, is the work of: DP 2025

a)S. H. Raza
b)Jogen Chowdhury
c)Tyeb Mehta
d)Anjolie Ela Menon

- The painting "**Mahishasura**" is a famous work by **Tyeb Mehta,** one of India's leading modern artists.
- In this artwork, he blends **Hindu mythology** (the demon Mahishasura) with expressionism, using bold lines and distorted forms to show **inner conflict, violence, and human struggle.**

Q3 The painting "Engagement Ring" (1961) by Roy Lichtenstein was based on a comic panel from which strip? DP 2025

a) Peanuts
b) Dilbert
c) Winnie Winkle
d) Blondie

Q4 Which Rajput palace is renowned for its "mirror hall" called Sheesh Mahal, displaying intricate mirror mosaics throughout the hall? DP 2025

a)Amer Fort
b)Mehrangarh Fort
c)Udaipur City Palace
d)Chittorgarh

Amer Fort

- **Built by**: Raja Man Singh I (16th century)

Mehrangarh Fort

- **Built by**: Rao Jodha (1459)
- One of the largest forts in India

Udaipur City Palace

- **Built by:** Maharana Udai Singh II (1559)
- Largest palace complex in Rajasthan
- Mix of Rajasthani and Mughal styles

Chittorgarh Fort

- **Built by:** Traditionally attributed to Bappa Rawal (7th century)
- One of the largest forts in India (UNESCO site)
- Famous for Vijay Stambh (Victory Tower)

Q5 Consider the following statements about the structural differences between Nagara and Dravida temple styles and choose the correct option.

DP 2025

Statement I: Dravida temples are architecturally distinct because they are enclosed within a compound wall, a feature typically absent in Nagara temples.

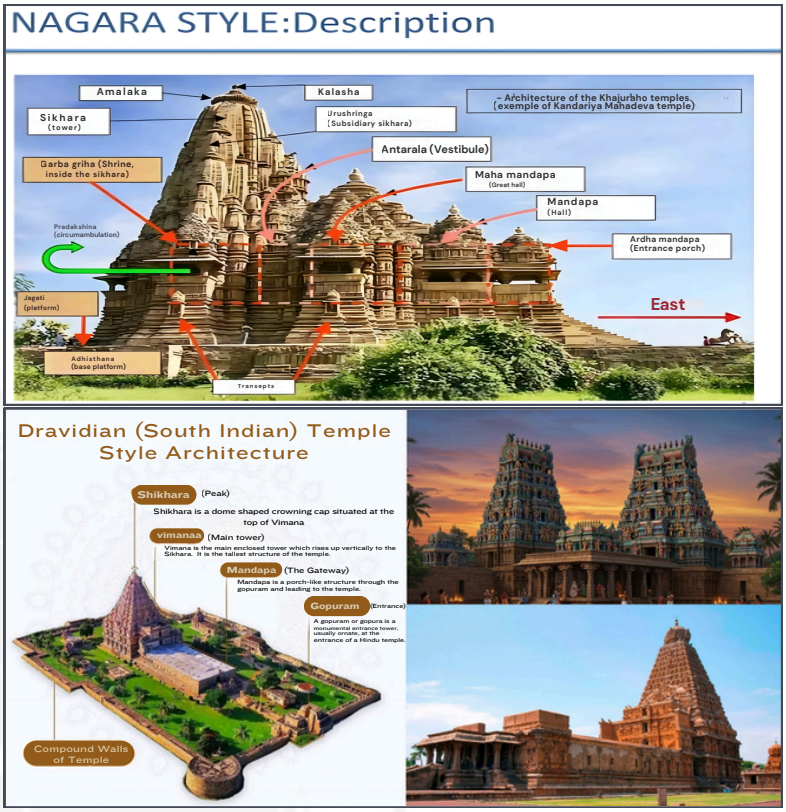
Statement II: The shape of the central temple tower in the Dravida style (Vimana) is similar to the curving sikhara of the Nagara style.

a)Statement I is correct, but Statement II is incorrect.

b)Statement I is incorrect, but Statement II is correct.

c)Both Statement I and Statement II are correct.

d)Both Statement I and Statement II are incorrect



Q6 Which temple is a prime example of Kalinga architecture, featuring a tall shikhara (Rekha Deul) and elaborate carvings?

DP 2025

a)Konark Sun Temple

b)Khajuraho

c)Meenakshi Temple

d)Lingaraja Temple

Konark Sun Temple

- **Built by:** Narasimhadeva I (1250 CE)
- Designed as a giant chariot of the Sun God (Surya) with 24 wheels
- Famous for intricate stone carvings

Khajuraho Temple

- **Built by:** Chandela rulers (950-1050 CE)
- Represents Nagara-style architecture
- Group of Hindu and Jain temples

Meenakshi Temple

- **Built by:** Kulasekara Pandya; later expanded by Tirumala Nayaka (12th-17th Century CE)
- Large temple complex with thousand-pillared hall
- Example of **Dravidian architecture**

Lingaraja Temple

- **Built by:** Yayati I (11th Century CE)
- Finest example of Kalinga architecture
- Tall shikhara (tower) over the sanctum
- Built mainly of sandstone

Q7 Consider the following statements about the earliest examples of temple construction materials and choose the correct option.

DP 2025

Statement I: The oldest surviving structural temples from the Gupta Period were primarily built using sandstone.

Statement II: The earliest known examples of the Ratha style of temples are found in Madhya Pradesh.

a)Statement I is correct, but Statement II is incorrect.

b)Statement I is incorrect, but Statement II is correct.

c)Both Statement I and Statement II are correct.

d)Neither Statement I nor Statement II is correct.

Pancha Rathas

Built by: Narasimhavarman I (also known as **Mamalla**) 7th century CE

- A group of five monolithic (single rock-cut) temples
- Each ratha is named after the Pandavas and Draupadi from the Mahabharata

1. Draupadi Ratha
2. Arjuna Ratha
3. Bhima Ratha
4. Dharmaraja Ratha
5. Nakula-Sahadeva Ratha

Q8 The murals in the Kailasanatha temple are painted using which technique?

DP 2025

a)Oil painting

b)Fresco-secco

c)Watercolour

d)Encaustic

Kailasanatha Temple

- **Built by:** Krishna I (8th century CE)
- A rock-cut **monolithic temple** carved from a single hill
- Part of the famous Ellora Caves
- Shows a blend of Dravidian architecture with grand scale and precision

- **Fresco-secco** (Italian term meaning "dry fresco") is a painting technique done on dry plaster.
- Seen in paintings of Ajanta Caves (along with other techniques)

Q9 Which famous Indian painter is renowned for his bold strokes and significant influence on modern Indian art, also referred to as the "Picasso of India"?

DP 2025

a)S.H. Raza

b)M.F. Husain

c)Tyeb Mehta

d)Nandalal Bose

Nandalal bose

- Was a renowned artist who decorated the original manuscript of the Indian Constitution, illustrating India's cultural heritage through traditional art and historical themes.

Q10 Consider the following statements about the Dasavatara Vishnu Temple, Deogarh and choose the correct option.

DP 2025

Statement I: Deogarh is considered one of the important sites of early temple construction in North India.

Statement II: The sculptures at Ellora are exclusively dedicated to Shaivism, showing only images of Shiva and his forms.

a)Statement I is correct, but Statement II is incorrect.

b)Statement I is incorrect, but Statement II is correct.

c)Both Statement I and Statement II are correct.

d)Neither Statement I nor Statement II is correct.

Deogarh Temple

- Built around 5th-6th Century CE
- During the rule of the Gupta Empire
- Known as Dashavatara Temple (means "ten avatars of Vishnu")
- Built in Nagara style (North Indian temple architecture)

Ajanta Caves

- Built between 2nd century BCE to 6th century CE
- Total 29 caves
- Mostly Buddhist (chaityas and viharas)

Ellora Caves

- Total 34 caves
- 12 Buddhist caves
- 17 Hindu caves
- 5 Jain caves

Q11 Pulikali, a folk art form, involves performers painting themselves as which animal?

DP 2025

a)Tiger b)Elephant

c)Lion d)Peacock

Q12 The temples of Khajuraho in Madhya Pradesh are associated with which architectural style, noted for ornate shikharas and erotic sculptures?

DP 2025

a)Dravidian

b)Nagara

c)Vesara

d)Kalinga

- **Khajuraho Temples** in Madhya Pradesh were built by the **Chandela rulers** (950-1050 CE) and are famous for Nagara-style architecture and intricate sculptures, including erotic art.

Q13 Which Rajput monument serves as a cenotaph rather than a fort or palace, built in memory of a ruler?

DP 2025

a)Jaswant Thada

b)Amer Fort II

c)Mehrangarh

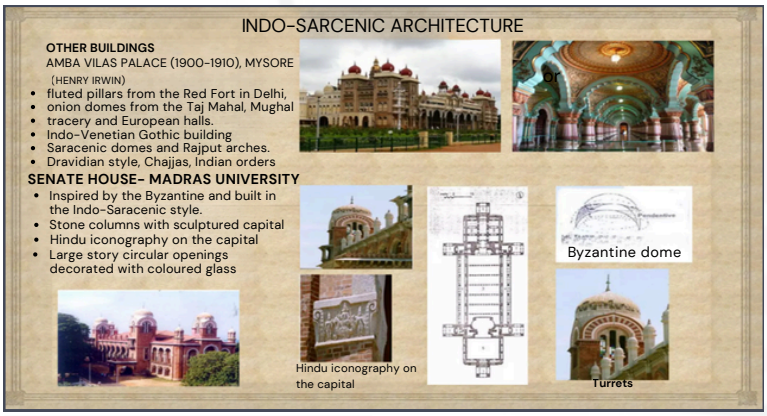
d)Hawa Mahal

- **Jaswant Thada** → Marble memorial in Jodhpur (1899)
- **Amer Fort** → Built in **1592** by Raja Man Singh, Hill fort in Jaipur built by Raja Man Singh
- **Mehrangarh Fort** → Massive fort in Jodhpur by Rao Jodha
- **Hawa Mahal** → Built in 1799 by Maharaja Sawai Pratap Singh, Palace with 953 windows **(jharokhas)** in Jaipur

Q14 Which of the following structures exemplifies Indo-Saracenic architecture, blending Gothic and Mughal features prominently in India? DP 2025

a)Victoria Memorial
b)Lotus Temple
c)Hampi Temple Complex
d)Golden Temple

- **Victoria Memorial** → A grand white marble monument built between 1906–1921 in memory of Queen Victoria. It reflects British colonial architecture and now serves as a museum.
- **Lotus Temple** → Built in 1986, this Bahá'í House of Worship is shaped like a lotus flower. Open to all religions
- **Hampi Temple Complex** → A UNESCO World Heritage site, it consists of temples built during the Vijayanagara Empire. Known for Dravidian architecture and rich history.
- **Golden Temple** → Also called **Harmandir Sahib**, it is the holiest shrine of Sikhism, founded by Guru Ram Das. Famous for its golden structure and spiritual atmosphere.



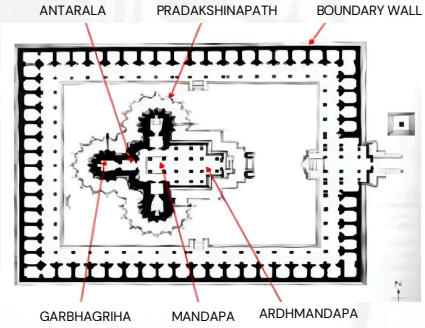
Q15 The term 'Vesara' refers to an architectural style that developed in which Indian region, combining elements of North and South Indian temple designs? DP 2025

a)North India
b)Deccan
c)East India
d)West India

Features of Vesara style of architecture

Basic layout of plan

- **The boundary wall of the complex**: Small cell as in the wall as enclosure and facing the main shrine in a rectangular courtyard.
- **Ardhmandapa:** A porch directing to the central hall.
- **Mandapa:** The main pillared hall came from the porch.
- **Mahamandapa:** The projection on either side of the main hall.
- **Garbhagriha:** Cella of the "womb house" including the idol with an opening on the eastern side.
- **Antarala:** vestibule or an intermediate space connecting the cella (Garbhagriha) and Hall (Mandapa).
- **Pradakshinapath:** Circumambulatory path around the cella for the devotees to move around deity.



Q16 Which Rajput fort, built atop a hill in Jodhpur, is famously called the "Mountain Fortress" due to its strategic location and massive defensive walls? DP 2025

a)Chittorgarh
b)Mehrangarh
c)Gwalior
d)Amer

Q17 The 'Lingaraja Temple', one of the finest examples of Hindu temple architecture, is located in which city? DP 2025

a)Puri
b)Konark
c)Bhubaneswar
d)Khajuraho

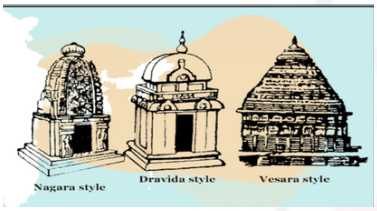
Q18 Which temple complex represents the Chalukya Vesara architectural style, combining features of both Dravidian and Nagara traditions in a distinctive hybrid seen in medieval Karnataka temples?

DP 2025

a)Pattadakal temples
b)Khajuraho
c)Lingaraja
d)Konark

Pattadakal Temples

- **Built by the** Chalukya Dynasty (7th-8th Century CE)
- 10 major temples (both Hindu and Jain)
- Famous temples include **Virupaksha and Mallikarjuna**
- Recognised as a **UNESCO World Heritage** Site



Q19 Which Mughal emperor commissioned the Jama Masjid in Delhi, constructed with red sandstone and marble, featuring domes and minarets?

DP 2025

a)Akbar
b)Shah Jahan
c)Humayun
d)Jahangir

Jama Masjid (Delhi)

- **Built in 1656**, it is one of India's largest mosques, known for its grand red sandstone and marble architecture.

Jama Masjid (Agra)

- **Built in** 1648 by **Jahanara Begum**, daughter of Shah Jahan, it is a beautiful mosque in Agra known for its elegant design and decoration.

Q20 Fill in the blank:
____ is the renowned Indian sculptor who created the "Statue of Unity".

DP 2025

a)Ram V. Sutar
b)Nandalal Bose
c)Prem Behari Narain Raizada
d)Satish Gujral

Q21 Charminar in Hyderabad incorporates which combination of architectural influences in its arches, minarets, and stucco decoration?

DP 2025

a)Rajput and Maratha
b)Persian, Hindu, and Islamic
c)Dravidian and Vijayanagara
d)French Colonial

Charminar

- 1591 by Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah
- Famous monument with four minarets (towers)
- Example of Indo-Islamic architecture with arches and domes

Q22 Which of the following sites is known for prehistoric paintings and is a UNESCO World Heritage site?

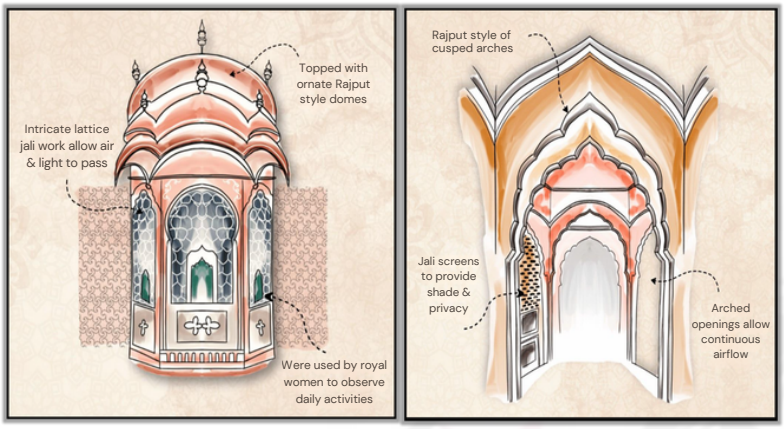
DP 2025

a)Ellora
b)Bhimbetka
c)Konark
d)Ajanta

- Bhimbetka Rock Shelters were discovered in **1957 by V. S. Wakankar.**
- These shelters contain prehistoric cave paintings showing early human life, hunting scenes, and cultural evolution.

Q23 The intricate overhanging balconies in Hawa Mahal are known by which architectural term? DP 2025

a)Jharokhas b)Chhatris
c)Iwans d)Mandapas



Q24 Mughal forts, such as Agra Fort, are noted for which defining architectural feature emphasizing defensive strength and ceremonial grandeur? DP 2025

a)Floating terraces
b)**Massive bastions and gates**
c)Dravidian gopurams
d)Curvilinear shikharas

Q25 The 'Dargah' (tomb) of the famous Sufi saint Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti is located in which city? DP 2025

a)Delhi b)Agra
c)Fatehpur Sikri **d)Ajmer**

Fatehpur Sikri

- Built in the 16th century by Akbar, Fatehpur Sikri served as the Mughal capital
- To honor the **Sufi saint Sheikh Salim Chishti**, who blessed him with a son
- As a symbol of his power and vision

Buland Darwaja

- Built by Akbar in 1601
- To celebrate his victory over Gujarat
- It is a grand entrance gate, symbolizing Mughal strength and success

Q26 The Ellora caves include temples representing which religious traditions in India, spanning the 6th to 10th centuries? DP 2025

a)Buddhist only
b)Hindu only
c)Jain only
d)Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain

Q27 The Ajanta caves, carved during the 2nd-6th centuries CE, are renowned for which architectural style, featuring chaitya halls, rock-cut monasteries, and elaborate mural paintings? DP 2025

a)Rock-cut Buddhist architecture
b)Gupta temples
c)Mughal forts
d)Rajput palaces

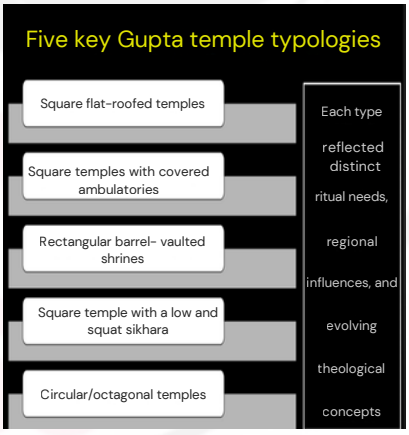


Figure 1. Parvati temple, Nachna, c465 (source: author)

Figure 2. Galaganatha temple, Pattadakal, 7th c (source: author)

Figure 3. Meguti temple, Aihole, c634(source: author)

Figure 4. Lad Khan temple, Aihole, 7-8 th c (source: author)

Q28 Which Rajput palace is popularly known as the "Palace of Winds," featuring numerous jharokhas for ventilation? DP 2025

a)Hawa Mahal
b)Amer Fort
c)Mehrangarh
d)Chittorgarh

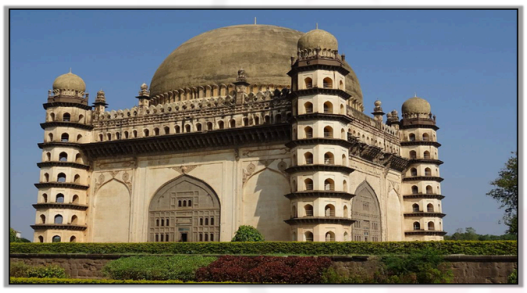
Q29 Rajput forts, such as Chittorgarh and Mehrangarh, are well-known for their defensive features. Which architectural characteristic primarily defines these fortresses? DP 2025

a)Lotus motifs
b)Massive thick walls with bastions
c)Stupa-shaped domes
d)Mughal arches

- Include **Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore, Gwalior, and Jaisalmer forts**, all known for strong defensive architecture.

Q30 What architectural feature is the Gol Gumbaz at Bijapur most famous for? DP 2025

a)Elaborate carvings
b)Huge dome and whispering gallery
c)Golden roof
d)Garden



Q31 Which of the following was the primary focus of Buddhist architecture and sculpture during the second century B.C.E.? DP 2025

a)Development of Hindu temples
b)Construction of Stupas, Chaitya halls, and caves
c)Expansion of Jain rock-cut temples
d)Creation of large-scale Mauryan sculptures

Karla Caves

- Built around 2nd century BCE
- Famous for the largest Buddhist chaitya (prayer hall)
- Known for grand pillars and rock-cut architecture

Kanheri Caves

- Built between 1st century BCE-10th century CE
- Over 100 Buddhist caves
- Used as a monastery and learning center

Bhaje Caves

- Built around 2nd century BCE
- Known for simple chaitya and viharas
- Early example of Buddhist rock-cut caves

Q32 Which Mughal structure is renowned for its pietra dura inlay work using semi-precious stones on white marble? DP 2025

a)Agra Fort
b)Taj Mahal
c)Red Fort
d)Fatehpur Sikri

Q33 Which of these terms refers to a type of architecture that is known for the southern style of temples? DP 2025

a)Dravida
b)Arsha
c)Mandir
d)Purna

Q34 Which rock-cut cave temple in Maharashtra exemplifies a combination of Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain architecture carved into solid rock formations? DP 2025

a)Ellora
b)Meenakshi Temple
c)Konark
d)Fatehpur Sikri

Q35 Which Mughal emperor commissioned the Taj Mahal, the iconic mausoleum built for Mumtaz Mahal, reflecting the pinnacle of Mughal architecture? DP 2025

a)Akbar
b)Jahangir
c)Shah Jahan
d)Aurangzeb

- **Ustad Ahmad** Lahori was a Mughal architect and chief designer of the Taj Mahal.
- **Padshahnama** is a Mughal chronicle written by Abdul Hamid Lahori describing the reign of Shah Jahan.
- **Shahnama** is a Persian epic poem by **Ferdowsi.**

Q36 In the Nagara temple, which element is the projecting central offset of the wall face?

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (MORNING)

a)Karna Sringa
b)Pratiratha
c)Anuratha
d)Bhadra

Q37 What is a key architectural feature of the Sun Temple at Modhera?

DP 2025

a)Gopuram
b)Garuda pillar
c)Stepped tank
d)Vimana

Sun Temple

- Built by: King Bhima I of the Solanki (Chaulukya) dynasty
- Period: Around 1026–1027 CE

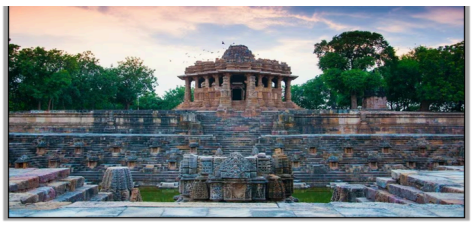
Architecture

The temple is built in Maru-Gurjara (Solanki) style and has three main parts:

1. **Surya Kund (Step Tank)**
- Large rectangular water tank in front of the temple
- Has 108 small shrines
- Used for ritual bathing before entering the temple

2. **Sabha Mandapa (Assembly Hall)**
- Pillars show scenes from Ramayana and Mahabharata
- Used for gatherings, dance, and rituals

3. **Gudha Mandapa (Main Shrine)**
- Sanctum where the idol of Surya was placed
- Designed so that sunlight directly falls on the idol at sunrise (equinox)



Q38 Which of the following is true about the Deogarh temple built in the early 6th century.

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)It follows a panchayatana layout and is an early example of Nagara style
b)It was built by Chandela rulers and faces east like most Hindu temples.
c)Its main deity is Shiva in the form of Mahadeo.
d)It is entirely rock-cut with vaulted interiors.

Q39 Consider the following statements about Chittorgarh Fort:

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (MORNING)

1. The fort features iconic structures like the Vijay Stambha and Kirti Stambha.
2. The fort complex includes nineteen main temples.
3. Its main entrance was established in the 5th century.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1,2 and 3

Q40 Which of the following best characterizes the Mathura school of Buddhist art and architecture?

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)Use of sandstone and floral arches
b)Hellenistic drapery and realism
c)Indigenous features with Yaksha influence
d)Predominantly wooden monastery design

Mathura School of Art

- **Period:** Mainly during the Kushan Period (1st–3rd century CE)
- **Material used:** Red spotted sandstone

Gandhara School of Art

- **Period:** Mainly during the Kushan Period (1st–3rd century CE)
- **Material used:** Grey sandstone and stucco

Feature	Mathura School	Gandhara School
Influence	Indian	Greek-Roman
Material	Red sandstone	Grey stone
Buddha Image	Spiritual, smiling	Realistic, serious
Clothing	Thin, transparent	Heavy drapery

Q41 Consider the following statements about Gandhara art beyond stone sculptures

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (EVENING)

1. A gold reliquary with figures in an arcade was found at Bimaran.
2. Intricately carved ivory plaques were discovered at Begram.

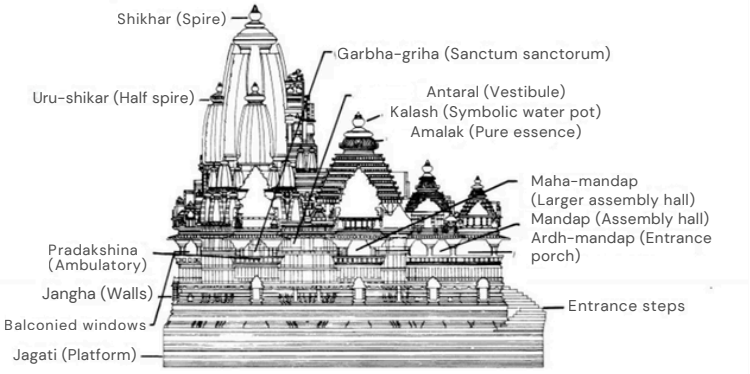
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a)Only 1 is correct
b)Only 2 is correct
c)Both 1 and 2 are correct
d)Neither 1 nor 2 is correct

Q42 What is the typical base design of the simplest Nagara-style shikhara?

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)Circular base with domes
b)Square base with curving walls
c)Triangular base with garden
d)Rectangular base with domes



Q43 Which architectural style predominantly defines the churches of Old Goa?

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)Indo-Saracenic
b)Mughal
c)Baroque and Manueline
d)Gothic Revival

Q44 Read the following statements and choose the correct option:

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (EVENING)

Statement 1 : The amalaka sits atop the shikhara in Nagara-style temples.
Statement 2 : In Drāviḍa-style temples, the vimana refers to the gateway tower (gopuram).

a)Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are correct
b)Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are incorrect
c)Statement 1 is correct, but Statement 2 is incorrect
d)Statement 1 is incorrect, but Statement 2 is correct

Q45 Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct options.

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (MORNING)

Assertion (A): Gothic Revival buildings in colonial India often employed pointed arches and ribbed vaults.
Reason(R): These elements were unknown in traditional European cathedrals.

a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A .
c) A is true, but R is false.
d) A is false, but R is true.

Q46 Which of the following features distinguishes the Elephanta Caves from other rock-cut sites of early India?

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (MORNING)

a) They are primarily Buddhist caves with large stupas.
b) The caves focus on Shaivite themes and feature sculptural depth through light and shadow.
c) They contain a mix of Jain and Vaishnavite depictions in pillar halls.
d) The caves are entirely monolithic structures from the Mauryan period.

Elephanta Caves

- Located on Elephanta Island (Gharapuri)
- Built in 5th–6th century CE, likely under the Kalachuri or early Chalukya rulers
- Originally called Gharapuri (City of Caves)
- Declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1987

Total 7 caves:

- 5 Hindu caves
- 2 Buddhist caves

Q47 Which of the following pairs of temple style & region are correctly matched ?

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

1.Vesara - Deccan
2.Rekha-Deul - Odisha
3.Bhumija - Malwa
4.Kalinga - Tamil Nadu

a)1 & 2 only
b)1, 2 & 3 are correct
c)2 & 4 only
d)Only 1

Q48 Which structural elements enhance the visual grandeur of Kangra Fort?

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)Wooden sculptures
b)Colorful glass windows
c)Arches, domes, and rock carvings
d)Painted ceilings and tiled floors

Kangra Fort

- In Kangra district, Himachal Pradesh
- Surrounded by steep hills, making it naturally secure
- Built by the **Katoch Dynasty**
- Attacked by Mahmud of Ghazni in 1009 CE, who looted its immense wealth

Q49 What is the main tower of a Drāviḍa-style temple known as?

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (MORNING)

a)Shikhara
b)Vihāra
c)Gopuram
d)Vimāna

Q50 How many pairs of decorative wheels are found on the Konark Sun Temple chariot?

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (MORNING)

a)10 pairs
b)11 pairs
c)12 pairs
d)13 pairs

Q51 Which of the following temple architectural features is characteristic of the Nagara style, especially found in central and northern India?

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)Vimana
b)Shikhara
c)Mandapa with barrel vaults
d)Gopuram

Q52 Which of the following statements is/are true?

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (EVENING)

Statement 1: The Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram exemplifies Dravidian architecture built of carved granite blocks.
Statement 2: This temple showcases architectural continuity from the Pallava-era rock-cut cave temples to fully structural stone constructions.

a)Both statements are true, and Statement 2 is the correct explanation of Statement 1
b)Both statements are correct, but Statement 2 is not the correct explanation of Statement 1.
c)Statement 1 is correct, Statement 2 is false.
d)Neither 1 nor 2

Notable Rock-Cut Monuments:

- **Pancha Rathas** (Mahabalipuram): Five distinct, single-rock temples demonstrating diverse architectural styles.
- **Varaha Cave Temple:** Known for its detailed sculptures.
- **Mahishasuramardini Cave**: Famous for its dynamic panel of Durga
- **Trimurthi Cave**: Dedicated to Brahma, Vishnu, and Shiva.
- **Transition to Structural:** The style evolved into structural temples like the **Shore Temple** (early 8th century) and Kailasanathar Temple in Kanchipuram, which mark the pinnacle of Pallava architectural achievements

Q53 The Sun Temple at Konark looks like a big chariot. How many horses does it have?

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)5 b)6
c)8 **d)7**

Q54 The Jagannath Temple in Puri is an example of which style of architecture?

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)Dravidian
b)Maratha
c)Nagara (Kalinga)
d)Vesara

Q55 The famous Meenakshi Temple in Madurai is known for which architectural feature?

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (EVENING)

a)White marble walls
b)Hidden underground shrines
c)Shikhara covered in gold
d)Gigantic Gopurams (gateway towers)

Meenakshi Temple

- Originally built by the Pandya Dynasty (around 6th century CE)
- Later rebuilt and expanded in the 16th–17th century by Tirumala Nayaka
- Situated on the banks of the Vaigai River
- **Dedicated to:**
  - Goddess Meenakshi (form of Parvati)
  - Lord Sundareswarar (form of Shiva)

Q56 What do the carved wheels on the Konark Sun Temple represent?

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (AFTERNOON)

a)Planets
b)Time divisions
c)Festivals
d)Weapons

Q57 Which Indian city is known for its abundance of buildings featuring French colonial architecture?

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (EVENING)

a)Goa
b)Puducherry (Pondicherry)
c)Hyderabad
d)Kolkata

Q58 The architectural style of ancient temples in Uttarakhand is primarily influenced by:

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (MORNING)

a)North Indian Nagara style
b)Indo-Gothic style
c)Vesara style
d)Chalukyan style

Q59 The rock-cut Kailasa temple at Ellora was carved out of how many rocks?

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (MORNING)

a)One single rock
b)Cement blocks
c)Three adjoining rocks
d)A cluster of stones

Q60 What is the architectural pattern of the Panch Mahal in Fatehpur Sikri based on?

SSC MTS - 2025

a)Jain temple
b)Buddhist Vihara
c)Rajput fortress
d)Persian mosque

Q61 Ekattarso Mahadeva Temple is also known as _____.

SSC MTS - 2025

a)Chausath Yogini Temple
b)Virupaksha Temple
c)Somnath Temple
d)Dilwara Temple

Virupaksha Temple

- Dedicated to Lord Shiva (Virupaksha).
- Built during the Vijayanagara Empire (7th century origins, expanded later).
- Patronized by rulers like Krishnadevaraya.
- Famous for Dravidian architecture and tall gopuram.
- Located at Hampi (UNESCO site).

Somath Temple

- Dedicated to Lord Shiva (Jyotirlinga).
- Originally built in ancient times (before 1st millennium CE).
- Present temple reconstructed under Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (1951).
- Symbol of resilience and faith.

Dilwara Temple

- Group of Jain temples.
- Built between 11th–13th century CE.
- Constructed by ministers of the Solanki dynasty (like Vimal Shah).
- Famous for white marble carvings.
- Known for extremely fine and detailed craftsmanship.

Q62 The Hawa Mahal is dedicated to which of the following deity?

SSC MTS - 2025

a)Lord Krishna
b)Lord Indra
c)Lord Buddha
d)Lord Shiva

Q63 How many distinct temples are there in the Dilwara Temples complex?

SSC MTS - 2025

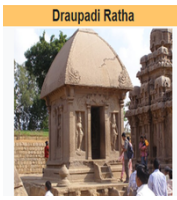
a)2 b)3
c)5 d)7

- The Dilwara Temple complex in Mount Abu Rajasthan, consists of Five distinct, major Jain temple, each dedicated to a different Jain Tirthankara. Famous for their white marble carvings, the five temples are: Vimal Vasahi, Luna, Vasahi, Pittalhar, Parshvanatha, and Mahavir Swami.

Q64 Draupadi Ratha is a _____ type of temple.

SSC MTS - 2025

a)chaitya
b)constructed
c)Elephant-back type
d)rock cut



Q65 Chandigarh has buildings designed by the _____ architect, Le Corbusier.

SSC MTS - 2025

a)German b)Russian
c)English **d)French**

Q66 The Sanchi Stupa gateways are known for sculptures depicting scenes from _____.

SSC MTS - 2025

a)Vedas
b)Ramayana
c)Mahavir Jain's life
d)Jataka stories

Sanchi Stupa

- Located in Madhya Pradesh, near Bhopal
- Originally commissioned by Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE.
- Later expanded during the Shunga and Satavahana periods.
- Declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site (1989).

Main Elements:

- **Hemispherical dome (Anda)** – contains relics of Buddha
- **Harmika** – square railing on top
- **Chhatra** – umbrella-like structure symbolizing honor
- **Vedika** – stone railing around the stupa
- **Toranas** (Gateways) – four decorated gateways in all directions

Q67 The blending of Greek and Indian art led to the development of _____ art which developed later. SSC MTS - 2025

a)Vaishali
b)Amaravati
c)Mathura
d)Gandhara

Q68 According to Jain philosophy, what is the main aim of the 'Syadvada' system? SSC MTS - 2025

a)Promote ritual sacrifices
b)Emphasize strict fundamentalism
c)Deny all forms of reality
d)Incorporate truths from multiple viewpoints

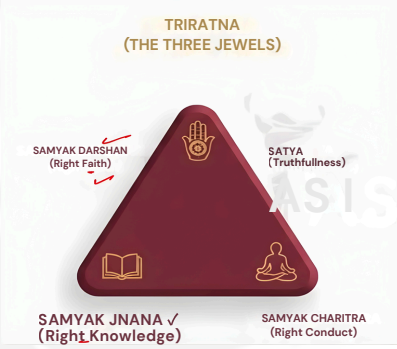
- **Anekantavada:** Reality has many aspects and no single view shows the complete truth.
- **Syadvada:** Every statement is conditional and expressed from a particular point of view ("Syat").

Q69 Which of the following best describes Chennai's architectural character? SSC MTS - 2025

a)Mughal domes and minarets
b)Rajput palaces
c)Buddhist stupas
d)British influence with cathedrals and tree-lined avenues

Q70 The term 'Samyakcharitra' in Jainism refers to _____. SSC MTS - 2025

a)Right faith
b)Right conduct
c)Right meditation
d)Right knowledge



Q71 In which Veda is river Sarasvati mentioned for the first time? SSC MTS - 2025

a)Sam Veda
b)Yajur Veda
c)Atharva Veda
d)Rig Veda

River	Mentions (approx.)	Notes
Sarasvati	~60–70 times	Most glorified; called "best of rivers"
Sindhu (Indus)	~150+ times	Very prominent; mighty river
Yamuna	~3 times	Minor mention
Ganga	1 time	Appears only once (RV 10.75)

Q72 Which of the following is the largest dome of India? SSC MTS - 2025

a)Adhai Din Ka Jhopra
b)Gol Gumbaz
c)Data Darbar
d)Taj Mahal

Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra

- After the Turkish conquest, **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** converted it into a mosque (1199 CE).

Gol Gumbaz

- Builder: Muhammad Adil Shah (17th century).
- Purpose: It is the tomb (mausoleum) of **Muhammad Adil Shah.**
- Famous for the **"Whispering Gallery"**—even a small sound echoes multiple times.
- **Style:** Deccan/Indo-Islamic architecture.

Data Darbar

- Associated Saint: Ali Hujwiri (11th century Sufi saint).
- Nature: It is a **dargah (shrine)**, not a monument built by a single ruler.
- Development: Built and expanded over time by different rulers and devotees.

Q73 Which of the following institutions was established by Rabindranath Tagore?

SSC MTS - 2025

a)Presidency College
b)Santiniketan
c)Fort William College
d)Hindu College

Institution	Year	Founder
Presidency College	1817	David Hare (+ R.R.M. Roy support)
Santiniketan	1901	Rabindranath Tagore
Fort William College	1800	Lord Wellesley
Hindu College	1817	David Hare

Q74 The Bhimakali Temple in Sarahan is a fine example of which architectural style?

SSC CPO - 2025

a)Chalukyan
b)Kath-Kuni
c)Dravidian
d)Indo-Gothic

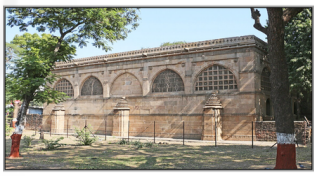
Bhimakali Temple

- **Location:** Sarahan, in Himachal Pradesh (near Indo-Tibetan border region)
- **Deity:** Goddess Bhimakali (a form of Durga/Parvati).
- **Importance:** One of the 51 Shakti Peethas (sacred sites of Goddess Shakti).
- Built in traditional Himachali "Kath-Kuni" style (wood + stone architecture).

Q75 For which architectural element is the Sidi Saiyyed Mosque in Gujarat famous for?

SSC CPO - 2025

a)Mirror mosaic domes
b)Lattice windows (jalis)
c)Spiral towers
d)Black marble minbars



Q76 What kind of architectural feature are the Jain temples known for?

SSC CPO - 2025

a)Highly intricate marble carvings
b)Enormous domes without any pillars
c)Bronze statues of horses
d)Gothic vaults and arches

Q77 Which of the following features are associated with the Gothic architectural style?

SSC CPO - 2025

a)Sloping tiled roofs
b)Pointed arches and stained glass windows
c)Flat roofs with courtyards
d)Domes with minarets

Q78 Which of the following ancient Indian sites is famous for its chaityas and viharas carved into rock? SSC CPO - 2025

a)Ajanta
b)Thanjavur
c)Mahabalipuram
d)Hampi

Q79 In which of the following shapes is the famous Sun Temple at Konark designed?
a)A lotus flower SSC CPO - 2025
b)A gigantic chariot
c)A circular stupa
d)A reclining deity

Q80 Which of the following Indian temple towns is a UNESCO World Heritage Site known for the Vijayanagara-style of architecture? SSC CPO - 2025

(a)Pattadakal
(b)Hampi
(c)Kanchipuram
(d)Thanjavur

ART & ARCHITECTURE OF VIJAYANAGAR EMPIRE

- Vijayanagara architecture, which flourished from 1336 to 1565 CE, was a notable architectural style that arose during the reign of the imperial Hindu Vijayanagara Empire. From their regalcapital at Vijayanagara, on the banks of the Tungabhadra River in modern-day Karnataka, India,the empire ruled South India.

1. Temple Architecture (Main Feature)

- Based on **Dravidian style** but more grand and decorative.
- **Huge Gopurams (gateway towers)** – tall and richly decorated.
- **Mandapas (pillared halls)** – used for rituals and gatherings
- **Kalyana Mandapa** – for divine marriage ceremonies.
- **Ample courtyards** and enclosure walls
- **Example**: Virupaksha Temple

Q81 The main temple of Shri Jagannath is an impressive and amazing structure constructed in Kalinga architecture, with a height of meters placed on an elevated platform. SSC CHSL - 2025

a)105 **b)65**
c)85 d)35

Q82 Which district is home to the Bhitrigaon (Bhitargaon) temple, a fine example of Gupta architecture? SSC CHSL - 2025

a)Jhansi
b)Kanpur
c)Gwalior
d)Allahabad

Q83 Which of the following temples is also known as "Taj Mahal of the South"? SSC CHSL - 2025

a)Sri Jagannath Puri Temple, Puri
b)**Meenakshi Temple, Madurai**
c)Sri Venkateswara Temple, Tirupati
d)Chamundeshwari Temple, Mysore

Q84 The Kailasa Temple built in the 8th century is in which of the following state? SSC CHSL - 2025

a)Madhya Pradesh
b)Rajasthan
c)Maharashtra
d)Gujarat

Q85 Who was the architect behind the design of the India Gate? SSC CHSL - 2025

a)Edwin Lutyens
b)Le Corbusier
c)Frank Lloyd Wright
d)Antoni Gaudi

- India Gate is a war memorial in New Delhi, designed by Edwin Lutyens in 1931, built to honor Indian soldiers who died in World War I.
- Inspired by triumphal arches (like Arc de Triomphe in France)

Q86 Which Mauryan architectural structure is famous for its beautiful, sculpted gateways? SSC CHSL - 2025

a)Sanchi Stupa
b)Amaravati Temple
c)Ajanta Caves
d)Nalanda University

Nalanda University

- **Established:** 5th century CE
- **Founded by:** Kumaragupta I
- Located in present-day Bihar, India
- Destroyed around 12th century (c. 1193 CE) by Bakhtiyar Khilji

Q87 Which art form developed as a result of the fusion of Greek and Indian artistic styles? SSC CHSL - 2025

a)Mathura art
b)Amaravati sculpture
c)Gandhara art
d)Gupta art

Q88 In Dravida style of architecture, the front wall has an entrance gateway in its centre, which is known as a _____. SSC CHSL - 2025

a)Gopuram
b)Pada
c)Prastara
d)Griva

Q89 In the context of Hindu temple architecture, the place where the main idol of a deity is placed is known as _____.

a)Garbhagriha SSC CHSL - 2025
b)Mandapa
c)Shikhara
d)Vaahan

Q90 The Jharokha in Rajput architecture is a type of? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Dome structure
b)Overhanging Balcony
c)Decorative pillar
d)Open courtyard

Q91 Consider the following statements about 'Bibi ka Maqbara'. SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

1. It was built by Mughal emperor Aurangzeb in memory of his wife.
2. It is located in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar and is called the "Taj Mahal of the Deccan."
3. It was constructed in the early 1500s during Babur's reign.

Which among these following is/are correct?

a)1 and 2 only
b)2 and 3 only
c)1 and 3 only
d)1, 2 and 3 are correct

Taj Mahal of the Deccan

- Also called "Bibi Ka Maqbara"
- A tomb (maqbara) located in Aurangabad
- Built in memory of Dilras Banu Begum (wife of Aurangzeb)
- **Built by** Azam Shah (son of Aurangzeb)
- Around 1678 CE

Q92 The famous Sanchi Stupa is associated with which ancient architectural tradition? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Hindu
b)Jain
c)Buddhist
d)Mughal

Q93 Which fort is an example of Rajput military architecture? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Red Fort
b)Agra Fort
c)Chittorgarh Fort
d)Golkonda Fort

Q94 Read the below statements marked as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Mark the correct options: SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

Assertion (A): Artists of the period 200 B.C. – 300 A.D. often carved nature-inspired scenes on Stupas.
Reason (R): These carvings were part of secular artistic expression blended with religious themes.
Option:
a)Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b)Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c)A is true, but R is false
d)A is false, but R is true

Q95 Which of the following is a key feature of Mathura school of sculpture? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Use of grey schist stone
b)Highly polished sandstone
c)Heavy Greek influence
d)Iconography of Buddha and Hindu deities

Q96 The Gothic architectural style originated in which continent? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Asia
b)Africa
c)Europe
d)Australia

Q97 The basic layout of early temples mentioned in the passage typically included: SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Stupa, Mandapa, Tower
b)Hall, Shrine, Veranda
c)Dome, Garbhagriha, Pillars
d)Sanctum, Shikhara, Cave

Q98 The Mathura School of Art flourished during which period? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Maurya
b)Gupta
c)Kushan
d)Chola

Q99 Which ancient culture greatly influenced the development of the Gandhara school of art? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Chinese
b)Greek
c)Persian
d)Egyptian

Q100 Which architectural style is the Brihadeeswarar Temple in Tamil Nadu known for? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Vesara
b)Dravidian
c)Nagara
d)Indo-Saracenic

Brihadeeswarar Temple
- Located in Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu
- Also known as **Rajarajeswaram or Peruvudaiyar Temple**
- **Built by** Rajaraja I
- Around 1010 CE during the Chola Empire
- Finest example of **Dravidian architecture**

Q101 Which school of art had more Hellenistic influence? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Mathura
b)Gandhara
c)Amaravati
d)Nagara

Q102 Which material was commonly used in Mathura sculptures? SSC PHASE XIII - 2025
a)Marble
b)Red sandstone
c)Bronze
d)Wood

Q103 The Gandhara art style is primarily associated with which religion?

SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Hinduism
b)Buddhism
c)Jainism
d)Zoroastrianism

Q104 Which metal casting technique was mastered by ancient Indian sculptors?

SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Hammer forging
b)Die-casting
c)Cire-perdue
d)Sand casting

Lost-wax technique (Cire Perdue method)

- his technique was highly perfected during the Chola Empire period.
- Used especially for making **bronze sculptures** like the famous Nataraja of Shiva.

1. A **wax model** is created
2. Covered with clay to form a mould
3. Wax is melted out ("lost")
4. Molten metal is poured into the mould

Q105 Which temple is known for its erotic sculptures and is a UNESCO World Heritage Site?

SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Brihadeshwara Temple
b)Sun Temple, Konark
c)Khajuraho Temples
d)Meenakshi Temple

Q106 Which Indo-French structure is a UNESCO World Heritage Site?

SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Fort St. George
b)Basilica of Bom Jesus
c)Auroville Matrimandir
d)Chandannagar Strand

Basilica of Bom Jesus

- A famous Roman Catholic church in Old Goa
- Built during Portuguese rule in India
- Built in 1605
- Houses the mortal remains of
- Built in **Baroque style**

Q107 The Mathura style of sculpture is distinguished by:

SSC PHASE XIII - 2025

a)Greek influence only
b)Indian indigenous themes with some Hellenistic influence
c)Purely Indian styles with no outside influence
d)Persian influence only

Q108 Which architectural style is best described by the following features: ribbed vaults, pointed arches, flying buttresses, and stained-glass windows?

SSC STENO - 2025

a)Mughal
b)Deccan
c)Indo-Islamic
d)Gothic

Q109 Which temple, built by the Chandela dynasty in the 10th-11th centuries, is known for its exquisite sculptures?

SSC STENO - 2025

a)Kandariya Mahadeva Temple
b)Brihadeeswarar Temple
c)Sun Temple, Modhera
d)Lingaraja Temple

Q110 Which of the following correctly pairs a monument with its architectural style?

SSC STENO - 2025

a)Khajuraho Temples - French
b)Qutub Minar - Indo-islamic
c)India Gate - Rajput
d)Lotus Temple - Mughal

Qutub Minar

- Construction started by **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** (1199 CE)
- Completed by **Iltutmish**
- Later repairs by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**
- Height: ~73 meters
- Made of red sandstone and marble
- Has 5 storeys with balconies
- Covered with Quranic inscriptions and carvings

Q111 What was the first published poetry collection by Vinod Kumar Shukla?

SSC STENO - 2025

a)Lagbhag Jai Hind
b)Kavita se Lambi Kavita
c)Aakash Dharti Ko Khatakhatata Hai
d)Woh Aadmi Chala Gaya

Q112 Read the following statements carefully and choose the correct option:

Assertion (A): The jaherthan plays a central role in the sacrificial rituals of Erok Sim.
Reason (R): The jaherthan is a sacred grove believed to be inhabited by spirits, including Jaherera, the Lady of the Sacred Grove.

a)Both A and R are correct, but R does not explain A.
b)Both A and R are correct, and R correctly explains A.
c)A is correct, but R is incorrect.
d)A is incorrect, but R is correct.

Q113 Which of the following statements is / are correct regarding the regional features of Gujarat's medieval architecture ?

SSC STENO - 2025

1. Architectural forms in Gujarat often incorporated elements from local temple traditions.
2. Structures such as mosques and tombs in Gujarat featured ornamental carvings like toranas and bell motifs.
3. Gujarat's architectural style strictly avoided any decorative influence from indigenous practices.

a)Only 1
b)2 and 3 Only
c)All 1, 2, and 3 are correct
d)1 and 2 Only

Q114 Match the following cave sites with their architectural characteristics:

SSC STENO - 2025

Column A- Cave Site	Column B Architectural Feature
A. **Udayagiri**	**Circular caitya with stupa and arch**
B. **Guntapalle**	**Pillared veranda with cells at the back**
C. **Khandagiri**	**Animal-shaped single rock excavations**

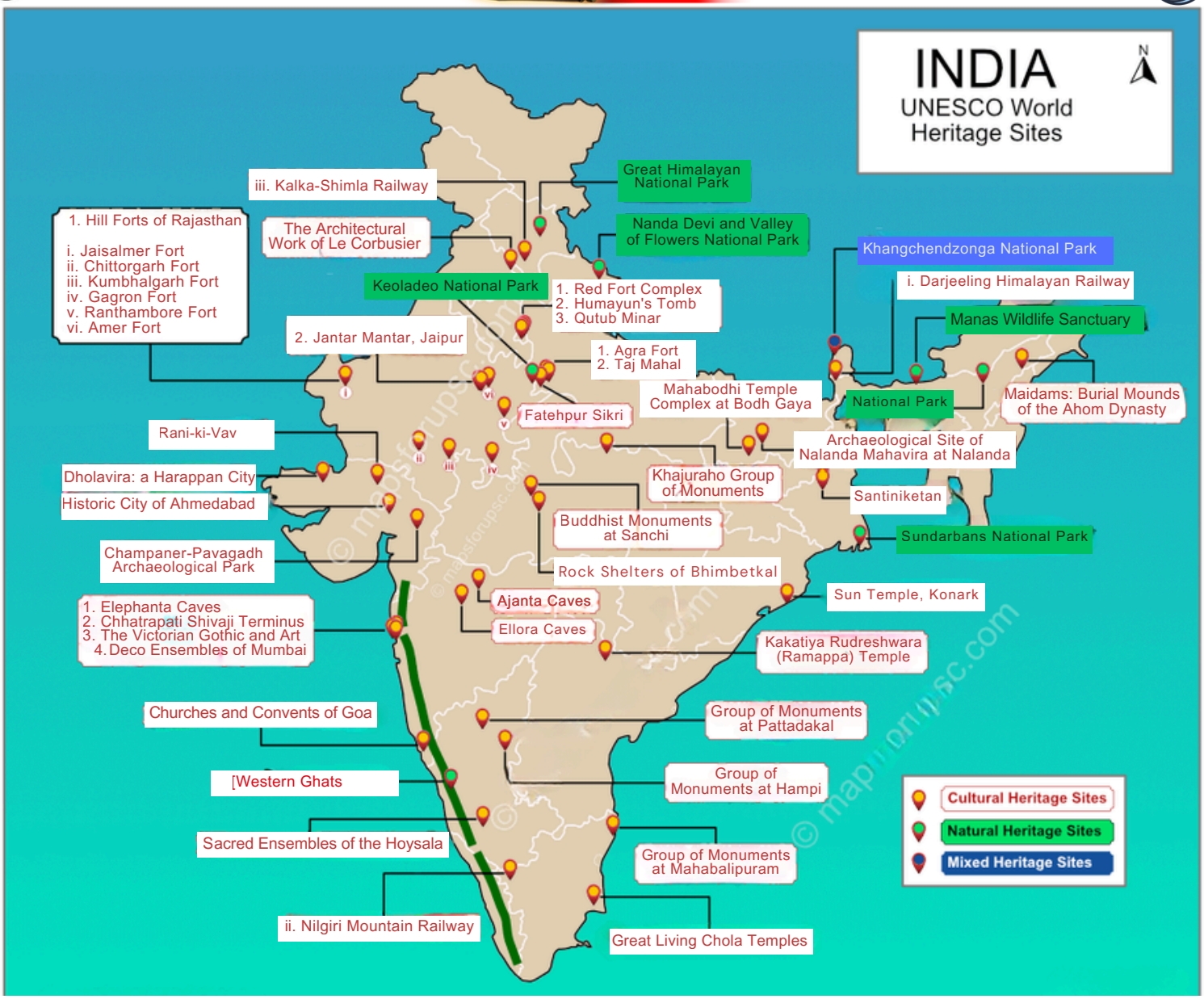
a)A - 3, B - 1, C - 2
b)A - 1, B - 2, C - 3
c)A - 1, B - 3, C - 2
d)A - 2, B - 1, C - 3

Q115 Consider the following statements regarding provincial architecture in medieval India and choose the correct option:

SSC STENO - 2025

1. Bengal and Jaunpur developed distinct architectural styles separate from the Delhi Sultanate.
2. Regional styles often blended Islamic structures with local artistic traditions.
3. Provincial styles remained completely uniform across all regions of India.

a)Only 1
b)1 and 2 Only
c)2 and 3 Only
d)All 1, 2 and 3 are correct



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